

Participant information sheet Future Women Leaders of Geoscience

Version 1, 17th July 2025

Research ethics approval number:

Name of researcher(s): Dr Katy Chamberlain (Project Lead), Dr Hannah Little (Project co-lead)

You are being invited to participate in a research study. Before you decide whether to participate, it is important for you to understand why the research is being done and what it will involve. Please take time to read the following information carefully and feel free to ask us if you would like more information or if there is anything that you do not understand. We would like to emphasise that you do not have to accept this invitation and should only agree to take part if you want to.

Background

Dr Katy Chamberlain and Dr Hannah Little are working on identifying barriers to leadership for women and nonbinary geoscientists.

To achieve this, they are surveying people working in geoscience about their experiences in leadership and what has supported or hindered them in taking on leadership positions.

We are inviting you to take part in a short survey which asks first about your background and protected characteristics, and then more specific questions about your experiences with leadership.

Participation is entirely voluntary, and you are free to withdraw your participation at any time without explanation, and without incurring a disadvantage.

By participating, you will be providing data that will be used to inform recommendations for training and resources to improve leadership skills for women and nonbinary geoscientists.

If you are willing to take part in this research, your participation will only require you completing an **online survey which should not take more than 10 to 15 minutes**. The survey will ask you to provide some information about your experience using both tick-box and open questions.

Responses will be anonymous and the results will be analysed for academic publications (e.g. journal papers or academic book chapters) and will be used to inform training and resources to address skills gaps identified by the survey.

As part of this study, you may optionally give your contact information on a separate expression of interest form to be informed about the results and any resulting publications, reports or recommendations. This separate form ensures that your data remains anonymous.

The University processes personal data as part of its research and teaching activities in accordance with the lawful basis of 'public task', and in accordance with the University's purpose of advancing education, learning and research for the public benefit.

Under UK data protection legislation, the University acts as the Data Controller for personal data collected as part of the University's research. Dr. Hannah Little acts as the Data Processor for this study, and any queries relating to the handling of your personal data can be sent to Hannah.Little@liverpool.ac.uk.

Your data will be anonymized and any identifying information (including information you may give yourself as part of an answer) will be removed from the survey results. Once you submit your

response, you will be given a participant code which corresponds to your recorded responses which you can use in the event of communicating about your data.

Further information on how your data will be used can be found in the table below.

How will my data be collected?	We will use Microsoft forms to collect responses from an online survey.
How will my data be stored?	Survey responses will be stored on a secure, password-protected server at the University of Liverpool. Only Dr Hannah Little and Dr Katy Chamberlain and a research associate will have access to this server.
How long will my data be stored for?	Private repositories of the data will be stored until the completion of the project and any resulting publications and reports have been published.
What measures are in place to protect the security and confidentiality of my data?	All data will be stored on a secure, password-protected server at the University of Liverpool which is only accessible by the research team (project lead, project co-lead and research associate).
Will my data be anonymised?	Yes, you will be given a participant code which corresponds to your survey responses which you can use in the event of communicating about your data (e.g. if you wish to request its destruction). Any information which may identify you from your responses will be removed.
How will my data be used?	Your responses will be analysed to identify how different protected characteristics interact with qualitative information about experiences of leadership and the barriers faced in taking on leadership roles. This analysis will be published, for example as part of journal papers or academic book chapters.
Who will have access to my data?	Only the project lead, project co-lead and research associate will have access to your submitted data.
Will my data be archived for use in other research projects in the future?	Yes, anonymised data will be archived to be of use in future grant applications exploring similar issues.
How will my data be destroyed?	Personal data will be deleted once the project has concluded and resulting reports and further grant work have been published.

Will I be remunerated for my time?

Survey participants will not be remunerated.

Are there any benefits in taking part?

Your data will be used to produce recommendations for resources and training to help issues of women and nonbinary scientists being underrepresented in leadership positions in geoscience.

Are there any risks in taking part?

There are no known risks in relation to participating in these surveys. You may refuse to answer any question at any time. If any participant experiences discomfort or disadvantage as part of the research, they should make the project lead (Dr Katy Chamberlain) aware immediately.

What will happen to the results of the study?

The results will contribute to the design of training which will be made available to women and non-binary geoscientists. The results will also inform future grant development to address the issues identified in this survey.

What will happen if I want to stop taking part?

You can withdraw your participation in the study at any time without explanation, both during the survey and after data collection. After 3 months, your data will have been used to inform a set of resources for leadership training, but you may still request we delete your records from our datasets.

If you withdraw part-way through a survey and you press submit, responses recorded before your withdrawal will be recorded. Otherwise, you may close the window at any time which will not record your responses or you may request that your responses are destroyed, and no further use is made of them. While responses will be anonymised, you will be given a participant code which you can use to request your responses are destroyed. As such, you should keep a record of your participant code and use this in correspondence with the project lead (Dr Katy Chamberlain), should you wish to communicate about or to withdraw your participation.

What if I am unhappy or if there is a problem?

If you are unhappy, or if there is a problem, please feel free to let us know by contacting Dr Katy Chamberlain (K.J.Chamberlain@liverpool.ac.uk) and we will try to help. If you remain unhappy or have a complaint which you feel you cannot come to us with then you should contact the Research Ethics and Integrity Office at ethics@liv.ac.uk. When contacting the Research Ethics and Integrity Office, please provide details of the name or description of the study (so that it can be identified), the researcher(s) involved, and the details of the complaint you wish to make.

The University strives to maintain the highest standards of rigour in the processing of your data. However, if you have any concerns about the way in which the University processes your personal data, it is important that you are aware of your right to lodge a complaint with the Information Commissioner's Office by calling 0303 123 1113.

Who can I contact if I have further questions?

Any queries should be directed to the project lead or project co-lead:

Dr Katy Chamberlain

K.J.Chamberlain@liverpool.ac.uk

University of Liverpool
School of Environmental Sciences
Jane Herdman Building
4 Brownlow Street
Liverpool L69 3GP

Dr Hannah Little

Hannah.little@liverpool.ac.uk

University of Liverpool
School of the Arts
Faculty of Humanities and Social Sciences
19 Abercromby Square (Office 328)
Liverpool L69 7ZG